

How the Digestive System Works

08/06/2026

Keywords: Carbohydrase, amylase, protease, amino acid, lipase, glycerol, fatty acid, soluble, absorb

Starter: Complete these quiz questions about last lesson

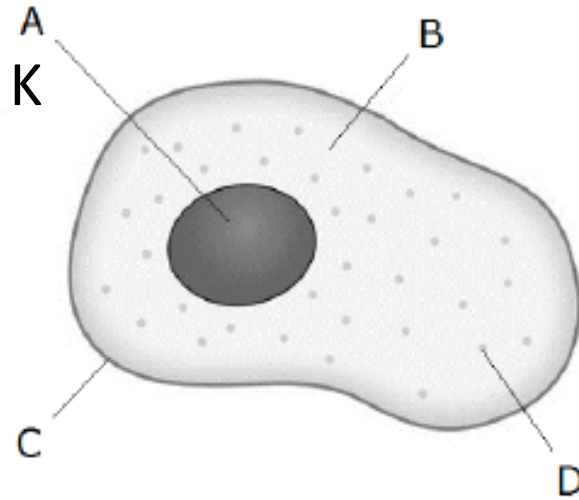
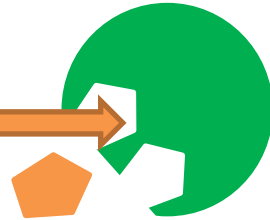
TIME FOR A

QUIZ!



Quiz 5: Factor Affecting Enzymes

1. Which enzyme is produced in the stomach a) Pepsin b) Amylase
2. Enzymes are made of what?
3. Enzymes are biological catalysts which means they speed up reactions in a) dead things b) natural things c) living things
4. What is the arrow pointing to A _____ s _____
5. What is the orange substance that joins with the enzyme for a reaction a) Substance b) Subject c) Sublet d) Substrate
6. What is the theory for how enzymes work L and K theory
7. What is part C
8. Name two things found in plant cells not found in animal cells V _____ and Chloro _____
9. Diffusion is the movement of molecules from a _____ concentration to a _____ concentration
10. Active transport and osmosis happens across a semi _____ membrane



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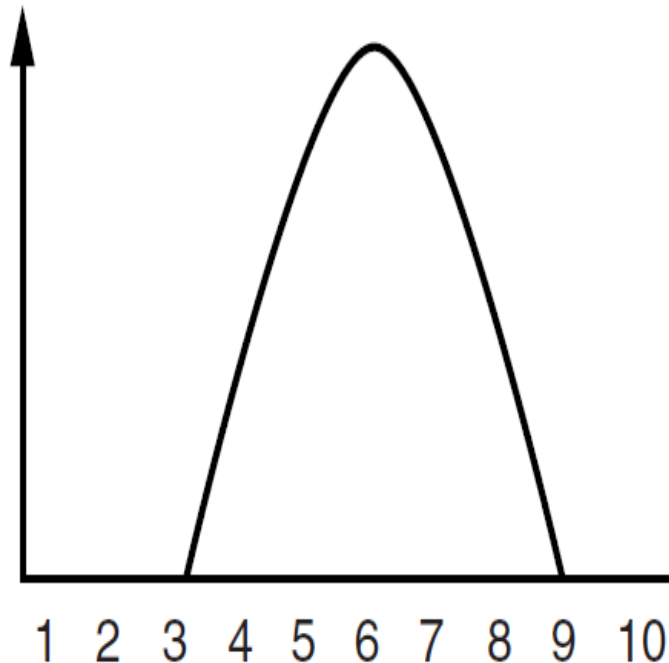
Keywords: Carbohydrase, amylase, protease, amino acid, lipase, glycerol, fatty acid, soluble, absorb

Starter: Answer these three review questions below.

EXT: What factors would affect how well the enzyme will work?

1. What are the missing graph labels? [2 marks]

2. Explain denaturing of enzymes and how it causes the rate of reaction to decrease. [3]



3. Explain why we get a temperature when we have an infection and why we try to decrease it. [4]

Review

1. What are the missing graph labels? [2 marks]

x axis = pH [1]

y axis = rate of reaction [1]

2. Explain denaturing of enzymes and how it causes the rate of reaction to decrease. [3]

*A process where **proteins lose their shape** due to pH or temperature limiting. It stops an enzyme being an effective catalyst because the **active site changes** shape and substrates can't fit.*

3. Explain why we get a temperature when we have an infection and why we try to decrease it. [4]

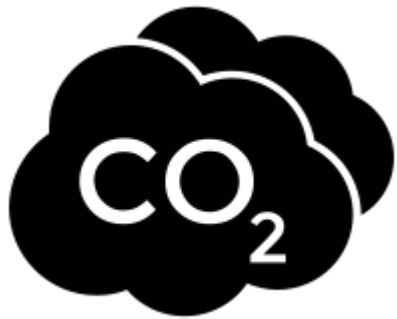
Some microorganisms can't reproduce at a higher temperature [1] Stops the infection spreading [1] High temperature can denature our enzymes [1] and we can die [1] so we try to reduce it.

LOb: Understand how the digestive system uses specific enzymes to absorb nutrients.

Keywords: Carbohydrase, amylase, protease, amino acid, lipase, glycerol, fatty acid, soluble, absorb

Learning Outcomes:

- Recall the digestive enzymes, where they are produced and what their substrate and product is
- Investigate the effect of pH on amylase enzyme



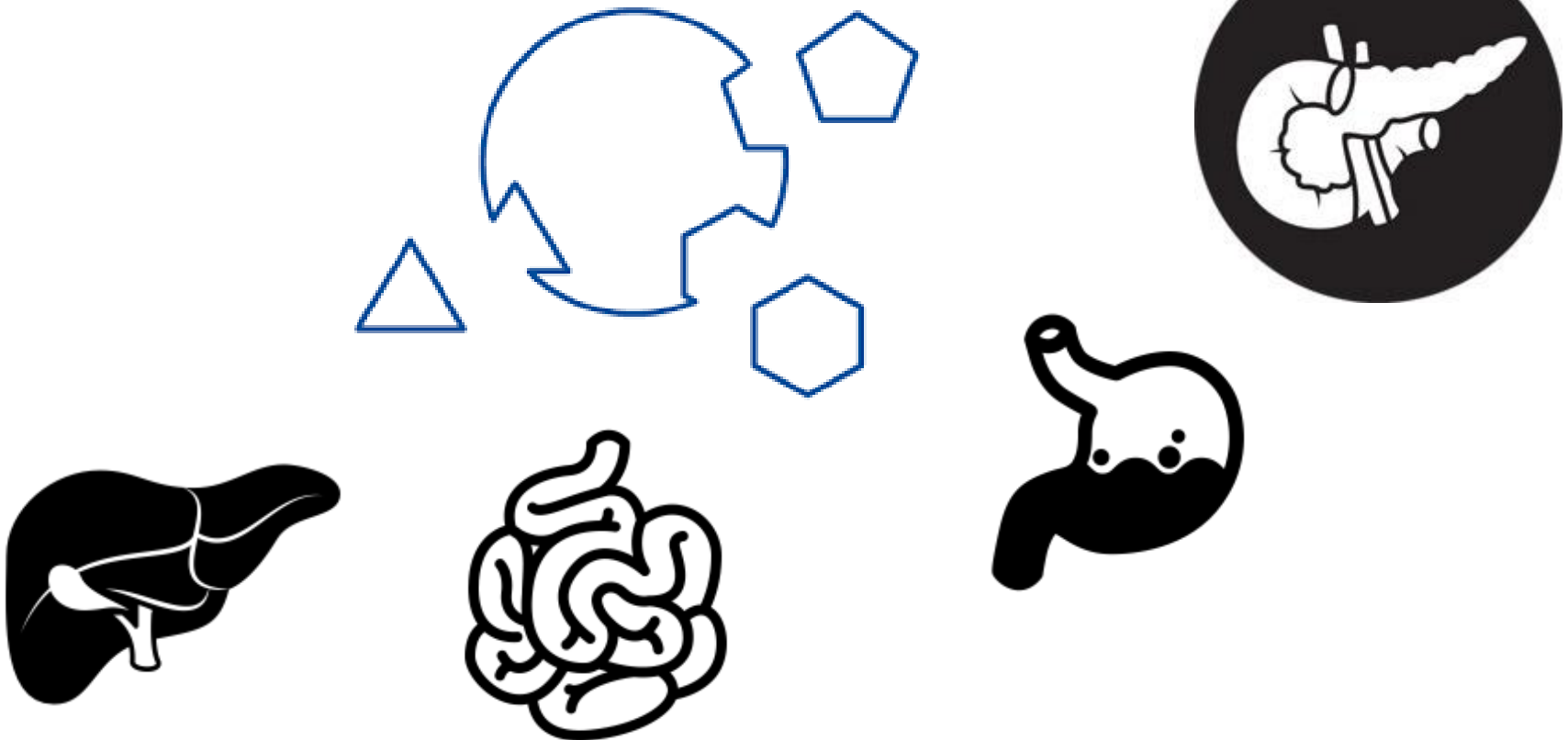
Did you know... carbonic anhydrase is one of the fastest enzymes known. Each enzyme molecule can hydrate 1,000,000 molecules of CO₂ per second.

What are Enzymes?

Enzymes are biological **catalysts** made from proteins.

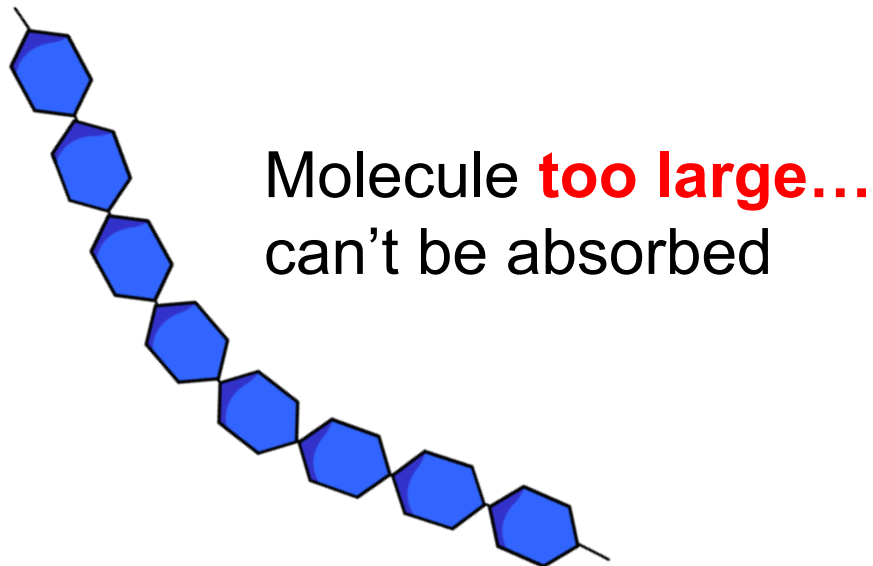
"A catalyst is something that speeds up a reaction". Enzymes help reactions in our body happen faster.

Substrate: Molecules that enzymes act upon



What is the role of digestive enzymes?

Digestive enzymes convert food into **small soluble molecules** that can be **absorbed** into the blood stream of the **small intestine**.



Small enough to be absorbed.



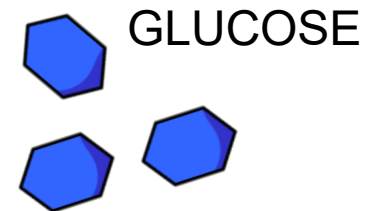
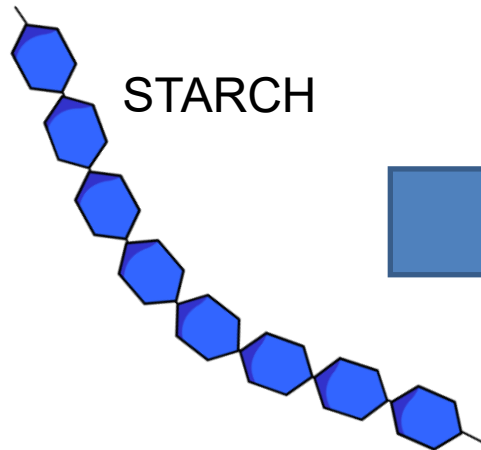


Organ → Mouth

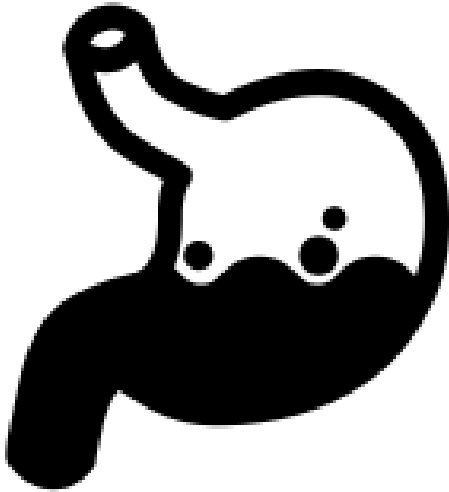
Enzyme → Amylase

What does it break down → Carbohydrate
called starch into
glucose

Substrate: Molecules that enzymes act upon



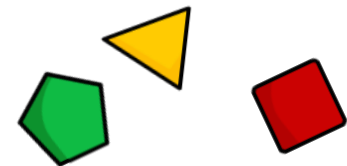
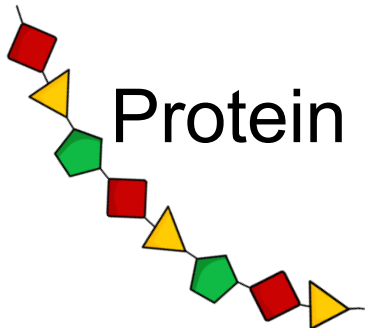
Organ → Stomach



Enzyme → Pepsin

What does it break down → Protein into Amino acids

What is the acid for → Help the enzymes Work better



Amino Acids



Organ → **Pancreas**

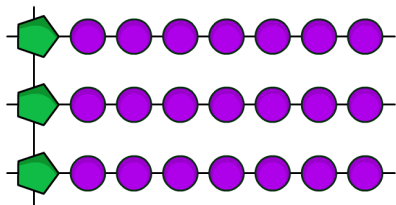
Enzyme → **Protease**, **lipase** and **carbohydrase**

What does it break down → **Protease breaks down protein**

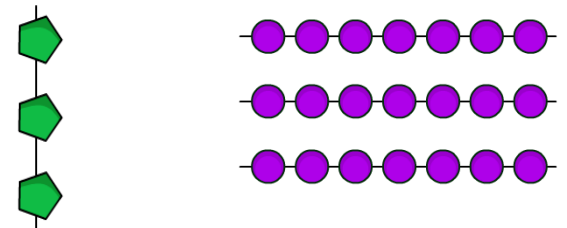
Lipase breaks down fat

Carbohydrase breaks Carbohydrate like starch

Fats



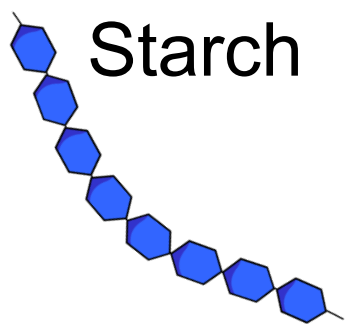
Fatty acids/ glycerol



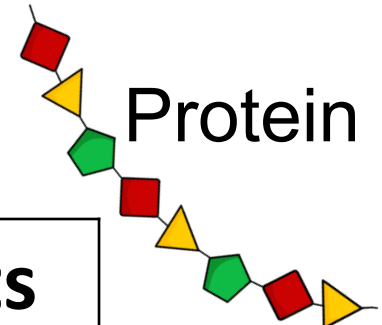
As we go through the following slides add into your sheet the missing information.

Substrate (draw a picture of it's structure)	Enzyme	Products

As we go through the following slides add into your sheet the missing information.

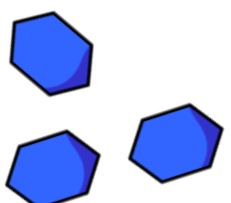


Starch

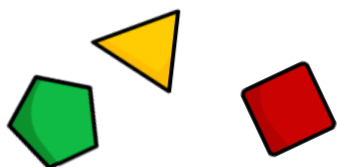


Protein

Substrate (draw a picture of it's structure)	Enzyme	Products
	_____ase	G_____
P_____		A_____A_



Glucose



Amino Acids

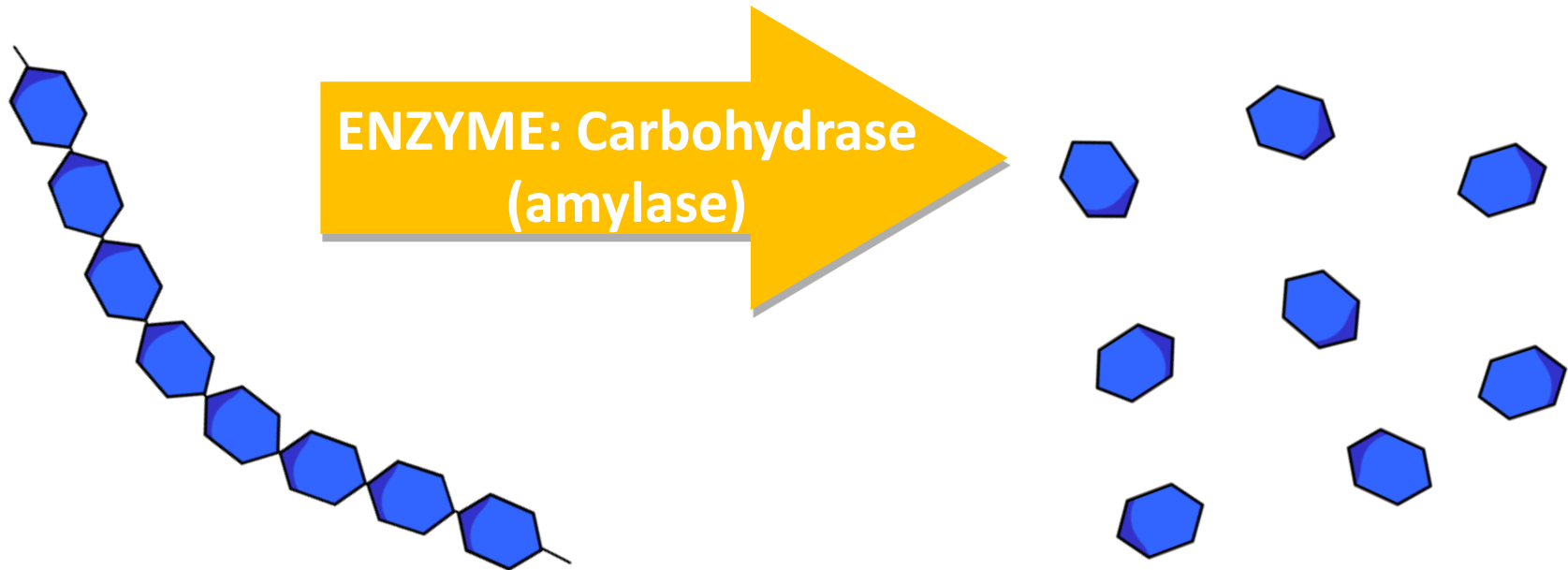
Carbohydrate digestion

Carbohydrates are chains of identical sugar molecules.

The digestive enzyme called **carbohydrase** breaks the chemical bonds between the individual sugar molecules in each carbohydrate chain. Digestion starts in the mouth.

SUBSTRATE
'Starch'

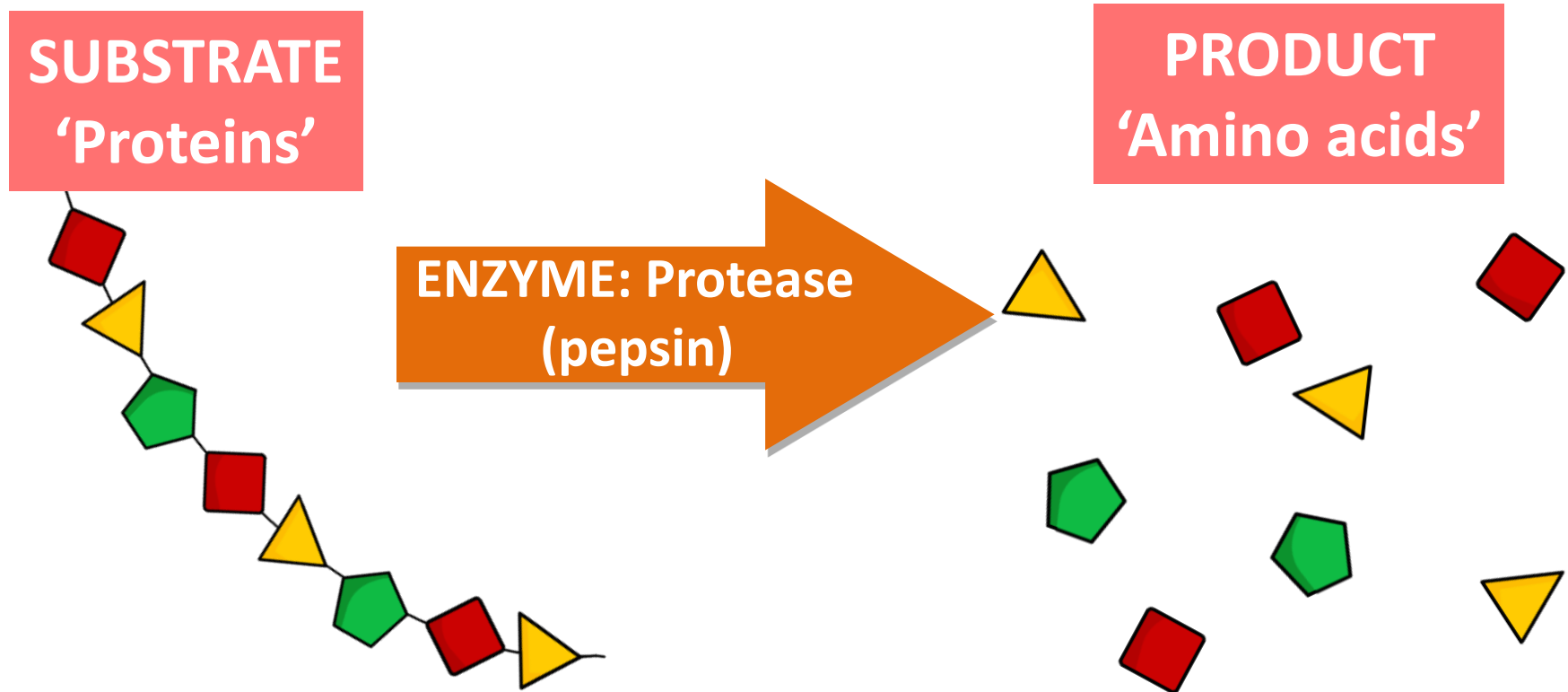
PRODUCT
Simple sugars 'Glucose'



Protein digestion

Proteins are made up of amino acids. There are over 20 different types of amino acids.

Proteins are digested by digestive enzymes called **proteases**. These enzymes work in the stomach and small intestine.

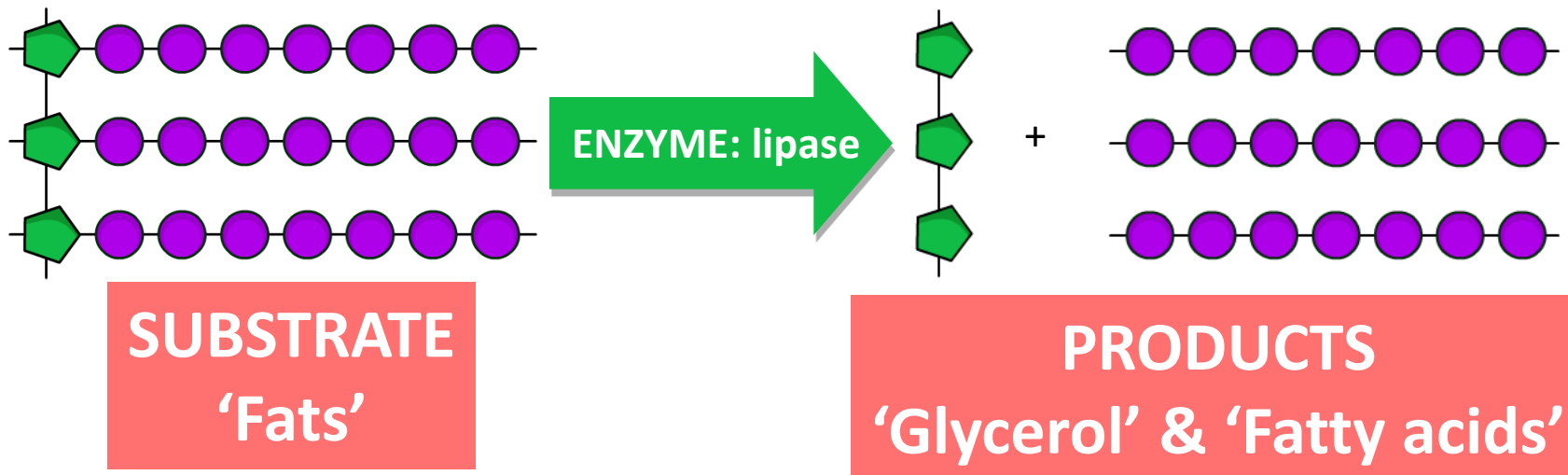


Two stage fat digestion in the small intestine

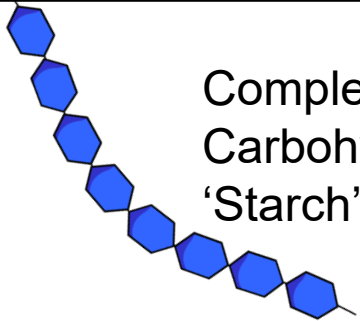
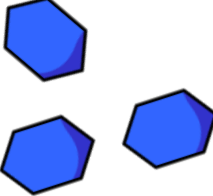
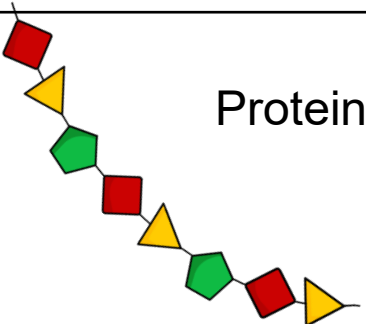
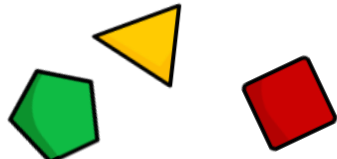
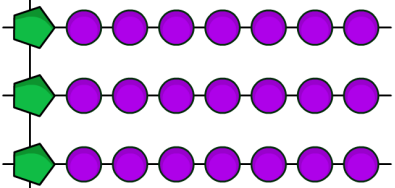
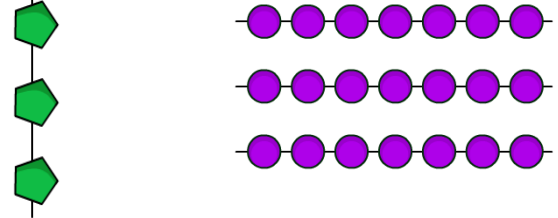
Firstly, **bile** (NOT an enzyme) allows the fat to 'mix' with water by breaking the fat into smaller droplets. This is called **emulsification**.



Secondly, the digestive enzyme **lipase** breaks each fat molecule into the smaller glycerol and fatty acid molecules.



As we go through the following slides add into your sheet the missing information

Substrate (draw a picture of it's structure)	Enzyme	Products
 Complex Carbohydrates 'Starch'	Carbohydrase 'Amylase'	Simple sugars Glucose 
 Proteins	Protease	Amino Acids 
Fats 	Lipase	Glycerol and fatty acids 

True

? ? ? **QUIZ** ? ? ?

False



Bile is an enzyme?

Enzymes are a catalyst?

The acid in stomach breaks food down?

Enzymes are made from amino acids?

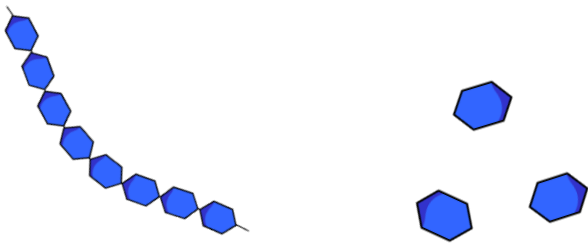
Catalyst decrease the speed of a reaction?

Enzymes are alive?



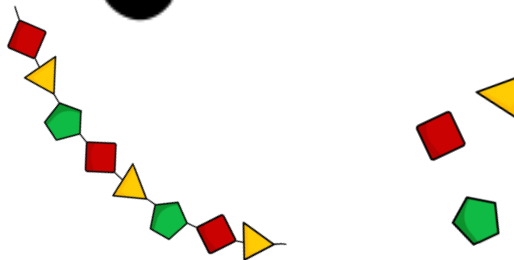
Digestive enzymes are found in these three organs

Amylase
carbohydrase
(Breaks down
Carbohydrate)



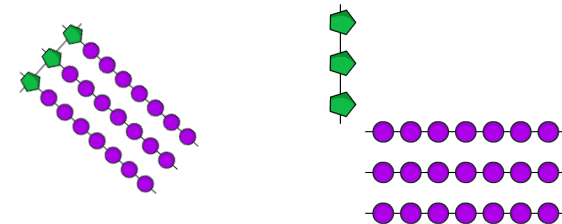
Starch → Glucose

Pepsin
protease
(Breaks down
Protein)



Protein → Amino
acids

Lipase
(break down
Lipids/fat)



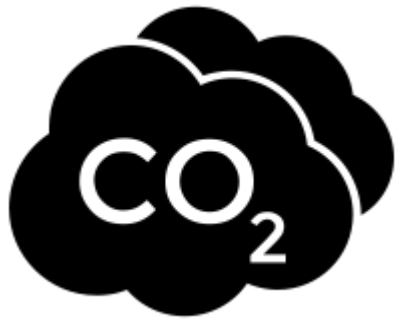
Fats → Fatty acids

LOb: Understand how the digestive system uses specific enzymes to absorb nutrients.

Keywords: Carbohydrase, amylase, protease, amino acid, lipase, glycerol, fatty acid, soluble, absorb

Learning Outcomes:

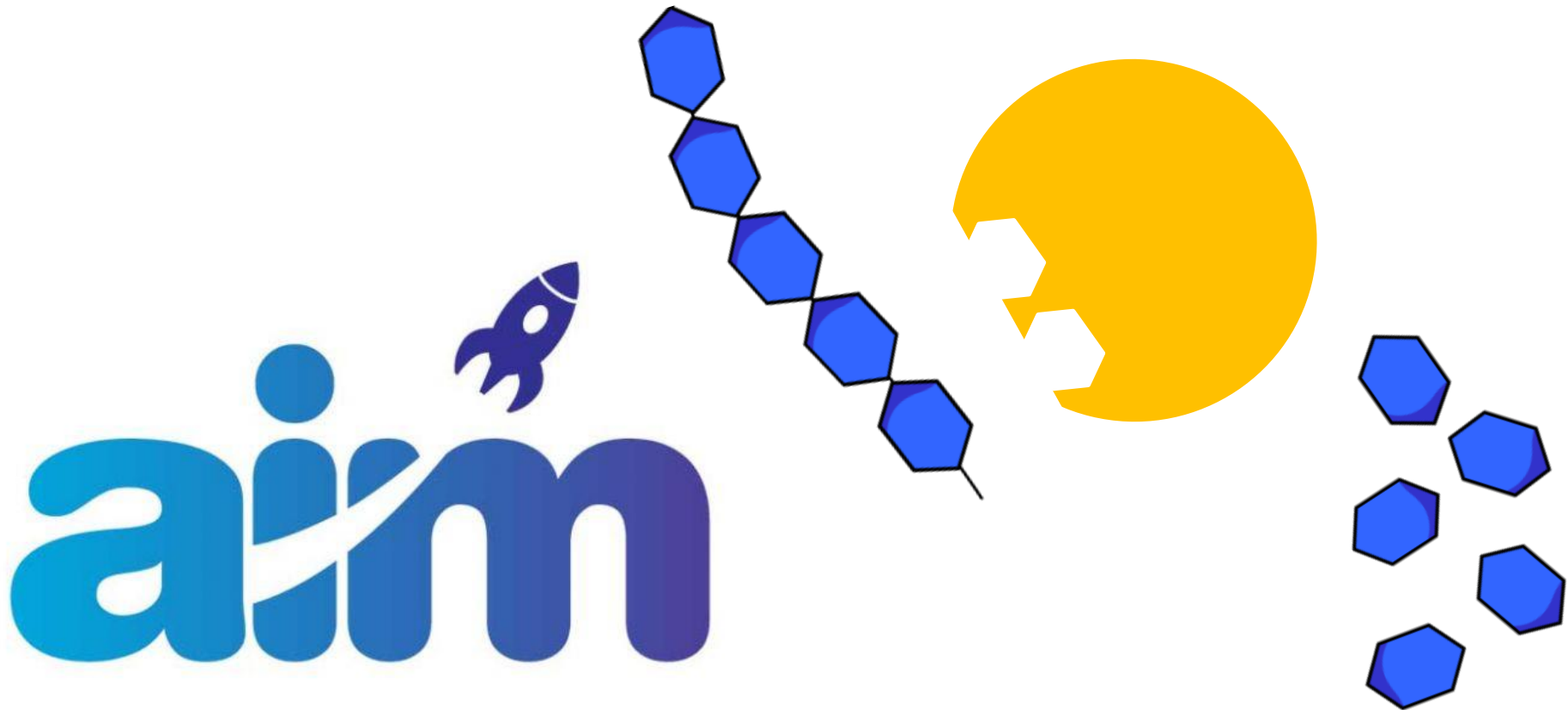
- ✓ Recall the digestive enzymes, where they are produced and what their substrate and product is
- Investigate the effect of pH on amylase enzyme



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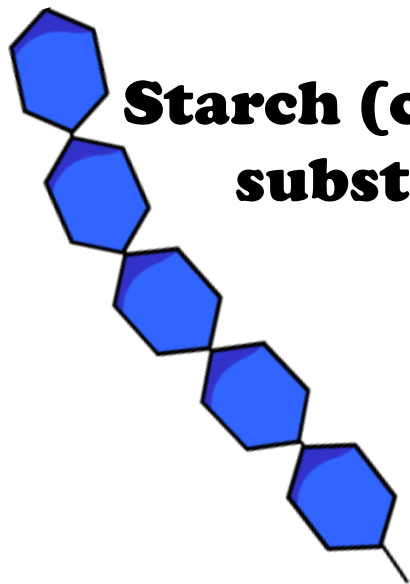
Experiment

"Investigate the effect of *pH* on the *rate of reaction of amylase enzyme*."



Background

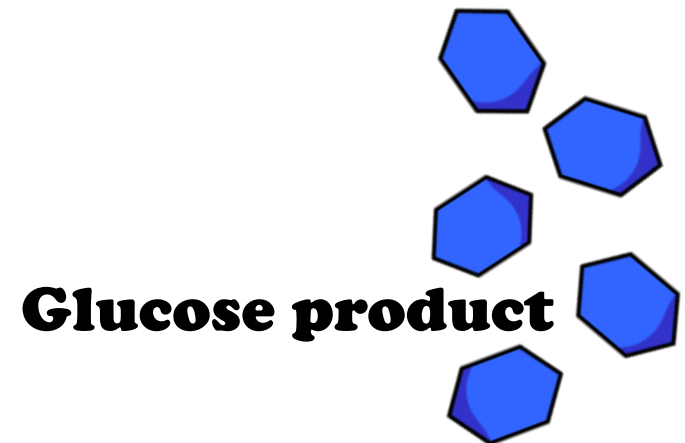
We want to see whether different pH solution increase or decrease the ability of amylase to turn starch into glucose. To do this **we need something that tells us when starch is present** and when it is no longer there.



**Starch (carbohydrate)
substrate**



**Amylase
(enzyme)**

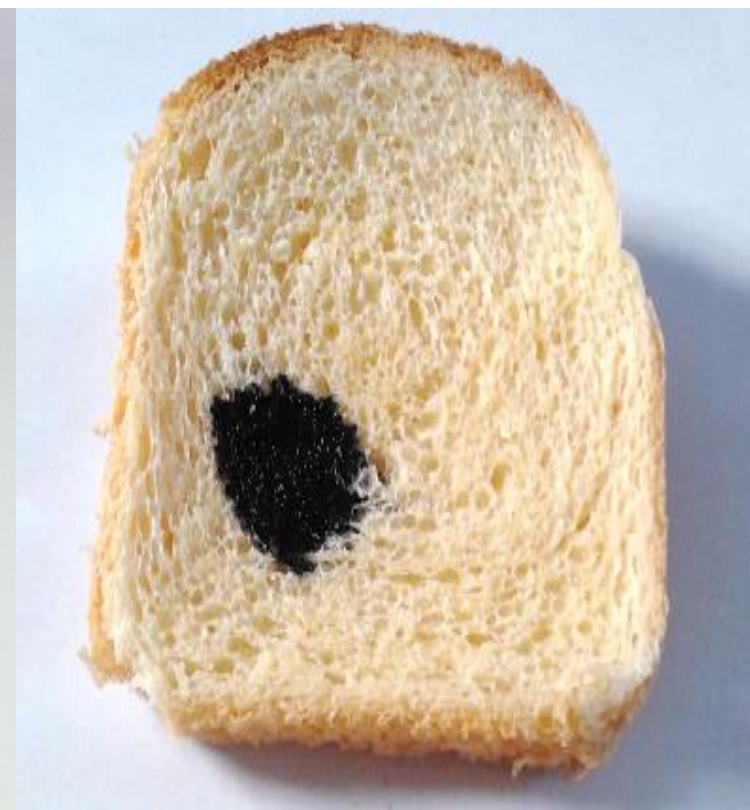


Glucose product

Test for starch – Iodine indicator solution

In the presence of starch iodine turns black.
When starch is not present iodine is orange.

● Starch
● No
Starch



Can we match the variable to the pictures?

INDEPENDENT VARIABLE



What I CHANGE



DEPENDENT VARIABLE

What I OBSERVE

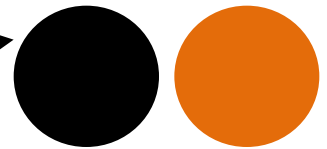


CONTROLLED VARIABLE

What I KEEP THE SAME



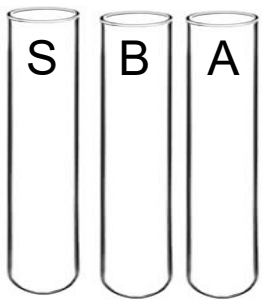
Temperature



Colour change



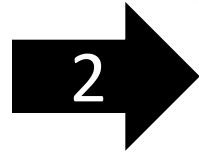
pH buffer



Label three test tubes.
One with the letter S
One with the letter B
One with the letter A
Place into a water bath
Keep as close to 35°



Stop once the colour is orange
and doesn't change. Record the
time by counting the number
of spots till orange.
Repeat with pH 6, 6.4, 7 and 8



Using a three separate pipettes
Place 2 cm³ of starch solution
Into tube S
Add 2 cm³ of buffer solution **pH 5**
into tube B
Add 1cm³ of amylase solution
Into tube A



When the solutions
are at 36° you are
ready to start



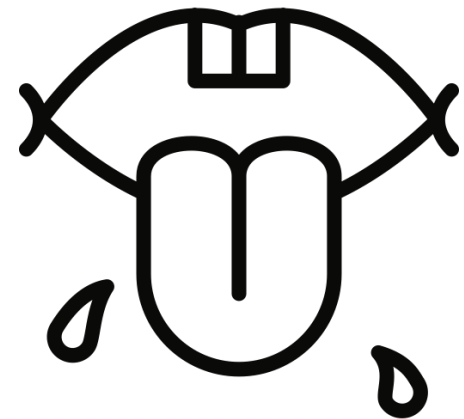
Add a few drops of
iodine solution into each
spot of the spotting tile.
Then transfer the
contents of test tube S
and B into tube A



Quickly take a pipette
and add a drop
of the mixture in tube A
into the first dimple
starting the timer. Repeat
every 10s

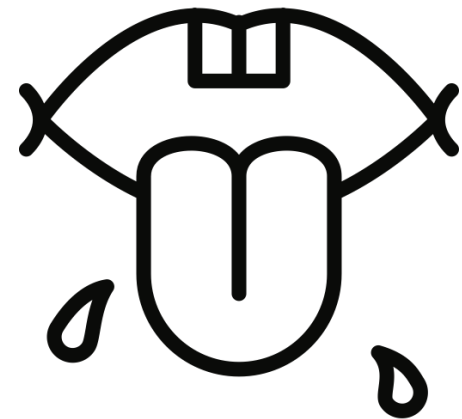
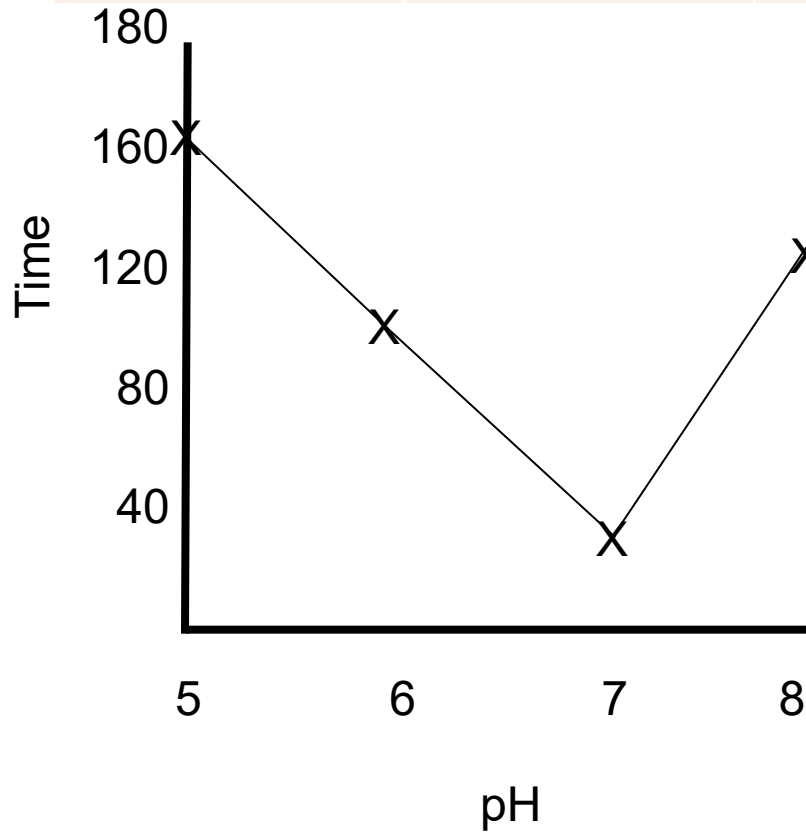
Saliva is between pH6-7. Copy table and complete the means results.

pH	Test 1 (sec)	Test 2 (sec)	Test 3 (sec)	Mean
5	170	150	170	
6	110	100	100	
7	30	40	30	
8	120	130	180	



Review

pH	Test 1 (sec)	Test 2 (sec)	Test 3 (sec)	Mean
5	170	150	170	163
6	110	100	100	103
7	30	40	30	33
8	120	130	180	125

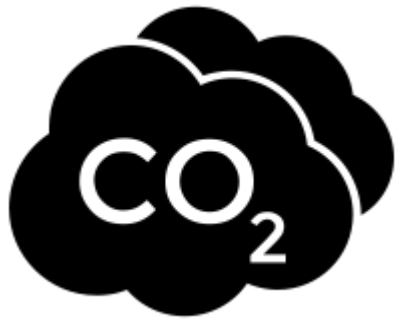


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Learning Outcomes:

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- ✓ Investigate the effect of pH on amylase enzyme



Did you know... carbonic anhydrase is one of the fastest enzymes known. Each enzyme molecule can hydrate 1,000,000 molecules of CO_2 per second.

keyfacts



Factors that effect enzymes: **pH, temperature, substrate and enzyme concentration, pressure, surface area**



Each enzyme has an **optimal condition**.



Temperature effects enzyme activity. **Cold temp = low kinetic energy reduced frequency of collisions.**



Denaturing at **high temperature** or a **pH range** means that the **structure of proteins** has been **irreparably damaged** which **stops the enzyme** from being able to **catalyse** a reaction.



H⁺ ions exert forces on enzyme protein structures which are either too strong or too weak to what they are used to so they denature.

Plenary: Chose a box

7. If I had to set a test based on today's lesson, I would ask the question:

4. With the information that I learnt today, I will now be able to ...